

TINKERER'S TRAPS



TINKERER'S TRAPS IS A 5TH EDITION COMPATIBLE supplement containing 12 Triggers and 19 Payloads for use in your campaign. Unlike conventional trap rules, this system separates the activation mechanism from the effect — allowing any Trigger to be paired with any Payload to create hundreds of unique trap combinations. This supplement requires the [free Tinkerer's Compendium](#) for all construction, repair, salvage, and parts rules.

A trap is a combination of two components — a Trigger and a Payload. The Trigger defines how the trap activates. The Payload defines what happens when it does. Each is built separately and combined at the table. Any Trigger can be paired with any Payload.

Trigger	Description
Tripwire	A wire strung across a path at ankle height. Activates when a creature moves through its space without noticing it. DC 14 to detect.
Pressure Plate	A concealed plate flush with the floor. Activates when 50 lb. or more is applied. DC 16 to detect.
Tension Wire	A wire connected to a container. Activates when the container is opened or the wire is broken. DC 16 to detect.
Counterweight	A balance mechanism connected to a chosen object. Activates when the object is moved or disturbed. DC 14 to detect.
Air Movement	A feather-tipped copper filament that detects air disturbances. Activates on significant air movement. DC 18 to detect.
Temperature Change	A copper filament that detects heat. Activates when a warm blooded creature comes within 10 feet. DC 16 to detect.
Timed	A clockwork countdown mechanism. Activates after a duration chosen by the trap setter. DC 14 to detect.
Vibration	A copper filament mounted to a surface. Activates when Medium or larger creatures move within 40 feet. DC 14 to detect.
Light/Dark	A lens and filament that detects light changes. Activates when light is introduced or removed, chosen by trap setter. DC 16 to detect.
Sound	A copper horn and filament that detects sound. Activates at ranges of 60 ft. (loud), 30 ft. (normal), or 10 ft. (quiet). DC 16 to detect.
Contact	A touch sensitive filament on an object or surface. Activates when directly touched or interacted with. DC 16 to detect.
Remote	A handheld trigger connected by wire to the payload. Activated manually by an operator at any distance. DC 18 to detect.

Payload	Description
Pit	A concealed excavation with a false floor. Creatures fall in taking 1d6 bludgeoning per 10 feet. Optional spikes add 1d6 piercing per 10 feet.
Spike Array	A spring-loaded array of iron spikes that deploy from any surface. DC 14 DEX save or 2d10 piercing damage.
Swinging Log	A heavy log that swings across a 10 foot arc. DC 14 DEX save or 2d10 bludgeoning damage and knocked prone.
Swinging Blade	A heavy iron blade that swings across a 10 foot arc. DC 14 DEX save or 3d8 slashing damage.
Portcullis Drop	One or more iron portcullises that drop instantly. DC 14 DEX save or 2d10 bludgeoning damage. Success allows choice of side.
Rolling Boulder	A boulder released along a set path. DEX save or knocked prone and bludgeoning damage scaling with size from 2d10 to 8d10.
Alarm	A spring-loaded striker and copper horn that produces a loud alarm heard up to 120 feet away. Eliminates surprise.
Cage Drop	An iron cage dropped to trap creatures. Available in 5x5, 10x10, and 20x20 sizes. DC 14 DEX save or 1d6 damage and trapped.
Caltrop Spreader	A spring-loaded mechanism that scatters caltrops in a 15 foot cone or 10 foot radius. DC 15 DEX save or 1d4 piercing and speed reduced to 5 feet.
Fire Projector	A concealed flamethrower with 5 shots. DC 14 DEX save or 3d6 fire damage. 15 foot cone or 25x5 foot line. Volatile on failed disarm.
Acid Projector	A concealed acid sprayer with 5 shots. DC 14 DEX save or 3d6 acid damage. 15 foot cone or 25x5 foot line. Volatile on failed disarm.
Adhesive Projector	A concealed adhesive sprayer with 5 shots. DC 14 DEX save or Restrained. 15 foot cone or 25x5 foot line.
Net Projector	A concealed net launcher that fires a net in a 15 foot cone. DC 14 DEX save or Restrained.
Gas Projector	A concealed gas release that fills a 20 foot radius. Smoke canister heavily obscures. Poison canister deals 2d6 poison damage per round.
Bolt Launcher	A concealed spring-loaded bolt launcher. Fires a single bolt dealing 1d10 piercing damage. Can be poisoned.
Spring Floor	A spring-loaded 10x10 panel that launches creatures 20 feet in a direction chosen by the trap setter. DC 10 DEX save or fall prone.
Magnetic Plate	A concealed 10x10 magnetic plate. Restrains creatures in metal armor for 1 minute. DC 14 STR save to break free.
Steam Vent	A concealed boiler and nozzle with 5 shots. Releases a 15 foot cone of scalding steam each round. DC 14 DEX save or 3d6 fire damage.
Electric Arc	Two concealed copper conductors with 5 shots. Creatures passing through take 3d6 lightning

COUNTERWEIGHT

Trigger

A concealed balance mechanism connected to a chosen object. When the object is moved, removed, or disturbed the counterweight shifts and activates the attached Payload. A favorite of those who wish to protect valuables.

Detection. DC 14 Perception check to notice.

Disarm. DC 12 Dexterity check to disarm. Thieves' Tools grant advantage on this check.

Parts. Trigger Mechanism.

Construction. 1 day, 2 gp + parts, Tinker's Tools DC 12.

Trigger. When the designated object is moved, removed, or disturbed the attached Payload activates.

AIR MOVEMENT

Trigger

A feather-tipped copper filament so sensitive it detects the slightest disturbance in the air. Unlike other triggers it does not need to be in the open to function, making it exceptionally difficult to spot.

Detection. DC 18 Perception check to notice.

Disarm. DC 12 Dexterity check to disarm. Thieves' Tools grant advantage on this check.

Parts. Trigger Mechanism, Copper Filament.

Construction. 0.5 days, 0 gp + parts, Tinker's Tools DC 12.

Trigger. Significant air movement such as opening a door or moving at normal speed activates the attached Payload. A creature moving slowly and deliberately may avoid triggering it at the DM's discretion.

TEMPERATURE CHANGE

Trigger

A copper filament calibrated to detect subtle changes in ambient temperature. When a warm blooded creature or other heat source comes within range the filament expands and activates the attached Payload.

Detection. DC 16 Perception check to notice.

Disarm. DC 12 Dexterity check to disarm. Thieves' Tools grant advantage on this check.

Parts. Trigger Mechanism, Copper Filament.

Construction. 0.5 days, 0 gp + parts, Tinker's Tools DC 12.

Trigger. When a warm blooded creature or heat source comes within 10 feet the attached Payload activates. Negating body heat entirely is required to avoid triggering it.

MAGNETIC PLATE

Payload

A powerful magnetic plate concealed beneath the floor that activates when triggered, pulling metal armored creatures to the ground and holding them in place.

Parts. Iron Magnet, Support Frame, Galvanic Cell.

Construction. 2 days, 20 gp + parts, Tinker's Tools DC 14.

Magnetize. When triggered the 10 foot by 10 foot plate activates. Any creature wearing metal armor within the area is immediately Restrained. A Restrained creature can use its action to make a DC 14 Strength check, freeing itself on a success. Doffing metal armor also frees the creature. After 1 minute the canister is spent and the plate loses power, freeing all Restrained creatures.

STEAM VENT

Payload

A concealed boiler and nozzle that releases a scalding burst of steam when triggered. The vent fires continuously for 5 rounds before the fuel is spent.

Parts. Flammable Liquid Fuel Canister, Leather Chamber, Hose.

Construction. 2 days, 15 gp + parts, Tinker's Tools DC 14.

Shots. The Steam Vent holds 5 shots. Each round of activation expends 1 shot. When all shots are expended the payload is spent.

Vent. When triggered and at the start of each subsequent round the Steam Vent releases a 15 foot cone of scalding steam. Each creature in the area must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 3d6 fire damage on a failed save or half on a success.

ELECTRIC ARC

Payload

Two concealed copper conductors that generate a crackling arc of electricity between them when triggered. Any creature passing through the arc is shocked. Metal armored creatures are particularly vulnerable.

Parts. Copper Filament, Galvanic Cell.

Construction. 2 days, 15 gp + parts, Tinker's Tools DC 14.

Shots. The Electric Arc holds 5 shots. Each round of activation expends 1 shot. When all shots are expended the payload is spent.

Arc. When triggered and at the start of each subsequent round any creature passing through the arc must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 3d6 lightning damage on a failed save or half on a success. Creatures wearing metal armor have disadvantage on this saving throw.

COMPATABLE PRODUCTS

TINKERER OBJECTS & RULES

- [Tinkerer's Compendium](#) — The free rules companion to the Tinkerer's series. Contains all construction, repair, salvage, and parts rules required to use any supplement in this line.
- [Tinkerer's Devices](#) — 18 large mechanical constructs deployed on the battlefield, from flame-throwing tripods and deployable barricades to mechanical cranes and scissor lifts.
- [Tinkerer's Gadgets](#) — 21 personal mechanical items carried and used by individual creatures, from wrist-mounted crossbows and spring-powered saws to breathing apparatus and throwable gas bombs.

MAPS

- [Tinkerton](#) - Maps of a Gnomish village including a Master Tinkerer's Workshop.
- [Cogworks Tavern](#) - Maps of a tavern frequented by Tinkerers.

MONSTERS & NPCs

- [Gearbound Gnomes](#) - A ladder of gnomes specialized in tinkering.

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